City of Saint Paul

City Hall and Court House
15 West Kellogg Boulevard
Council Chambers - 3rd Floor
651-266-8560

Meeting Minutes

City Council

Council President Rebecca Noecker
Vice President Nelsie Yang
Councilmember Anika Bowie
Councilmember Molly Coleman
Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson
Councilmember Saura Jost
Councilmember HwaJeong Kim

Wednesday, July 15, 2026 **3:30 PM** **Council Chambers - 3rd Floor**

ROLL CALL

Meeting started at 3:30 PM

Present 7 - Councilmember Rebecca Noecker, Councilmember Nelsie Yang, Councilmember HwaJeong Kim, Councilmember Anika Bowie, Councilmember Saura Jost, Councilmember Cheniqua Johnson and Councilmember Molly Coleman

COMMUNICATIONS & RECEIVE/FILE

1 AO 26-43 Amending CDBG Project Budgets: To allocate $41,961 of funding for 1133 Rice Street (Kwe Ka Baung Grocery LLC).

Received and Filed

CONSENT AGENDA
Items listed under the Consent Agenda will be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. If discussion on an item is desired, the item will be removed from the Consent Agenda for separate consideration.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Council President Noecker stated that Item 21 would be taken separately.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 6 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 - Councilmember Kim

2 RES 26-990 Approving the City's cost of providing Securing and/or Emergency Boarding services during May 2026, and setting date of Legislative Hearing for August

11, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. J2613B, Assessment No. 268119)

Adopted

3 RES 26-1024 Authorizing the City to enter into an Interconnection Agreement with Xcel Energy, which includes an indemnification clause, for solar at Frogtown Community Center.

Adopted

4 RES 26-1029 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during January to March 2026, and setting date of legislative hearing for August 13, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG26Q1B1, Assessment No. 260151)

Adopted

5 RES 26-1030 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during January to March 2026, and setting date of legislative hearing for August 13, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG26Q1B2, Assessment No. 260152)

Adopted

6 RES 26-1031 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during January to March 2026, and setting date of legislative hearing for August 13, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG26Q1B3, Assessment No. 260153)

Adopted

7 RES 26-1032 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during January to March 2026, and setting date of legislative hearing for August 13, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG26Q1B4, Assessment No. 260154)

Adopted

8 RES 26-1033 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during January to March 2026, and setting date of legislative hearing for August 13, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. CG26Q1B5, Assessment No. 260155)

Adopted

9 RES 26-1034 Approving the City's cost of providing Collection of Delinquent Garbage Bills for service during January to March 2026, and setting date of legislative

hearing for August 13, 2026 and City Council public hearing for September 16, 2026 to consider and levy the assessments against individual properties. (File No. YW26Q1B1, Assessment No. 260501)

Adopted

10 RES 26-1047 Authorizing Public Works to apply for $69,300 from the Minnesota Department of Commerce's Solar on Public Buildings Grant Program for solar installation at the Solid Waste & Recycling Facility.

Adopted

11 RES 26-1087 Authorizing the Department of Emergency Management to apply for the annual Urban Area Security Initiative (UASI) grant program from the Department of Homeland Security to enhance preparedness and capabilities to prevent, prepare for, protect against, and respond to acts of terrorism.

Adopted

12 RES 26-1089 Directing the Department of Safety and Inspections to revoke the Off Sale Liquor license (License ID #372977) held by Phann Liquor Inc d/b/a Capital Wine & Spirit for the premises located at 531 Rice Street.

Adopted

13 RES 26-1090 Authorizing the Department of Emergency Management to apply for grant funds from the U.S. Department of Homeland Security through its Federal Emergency Management Agency (FEMA).

Adopted

14 RES 26-1101 Approving the Mayor's reappointment of Hally Turner and Ianni Houmas to a three-year term on the Transportation Committee of the Planning Committee.

Adopted

15 RES 26-1104 Approving the Mayor's reappointments of James Thayer and Eva Wailes to the Human Rights and Equal Economic Opportunity Commission.

Adopted

16 RES 26-1102 Approving the Mayor's reappointment of Nieeta Presley, Brian Martinson, Simon Taghioff, Kristine Grill, Richard Holst, Jacob B. Reilly, Seanne M. Thomas, and Elizabeth Starling to the Planning Commission.

Adopted

17 RES 26-1103 Approving the Mayor's appointment of Marc Manderscheid to a three-year term on the Heritage Preservation Commission.

Adopted

18 RES 26-1119 Approving the use of Neighborhood STAR grant funds for a change in scope

of work for RealBigHuge Brewing Company LLC.

Adopted

19 RES 26-1122 Approving the use of grant funds through the Ward 2 Neighborhood STAR year-round program for Rascher and Co. LLC for 712 Smith Ave building facade restoration.

Adopted

20 RES 26-1147 Approving the reimbursement funds for the Ward 6 Budget Event.

Adopted

22 RES 26-998 Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreement (January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2028) and Memorandum of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the Saint Paul Supervisors' Organization.

Adopted

23 RES 26-1051 Approving the Collective Bargaining Agreement (January 1, 2026 - December 31, 2028) and Memorandums of Agreement between the City of Saint Paul and the Professional Employees Association, Inc.

Adopted

FOR DISCUSSION

21 RES 26-1150 Recognizing the Historic Legacy, Cultural Preservation, and Community Contributions of the Rondo Days Drill Teams and Dance Groups.

Councilmember Bowie gave remarks.

Representatives of various drill teams gave remarks.

Councilmember Johnson spoke in favor.

Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

ORDINANCES

An ordinance is a city law enacted by the City Council. It is read at three separate council meetings and becomes effective after passage by the Council and 30 days after publication in the Saint Paul Pioneer Press. Public hearings on ordinances are generally held at the second reading.

Final Adoption

24 Ord 25-4 Amending Title IV of the Saint Paul Administrative Code to add Chapter 92, titled Tree Preservation for City Sponsored Construction Projects.

Council President Noecker spoke in favor and moved approval.

Councilmembers Yang and Bowie spoke in favor.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

First Reading

25 Ord 26-35 Amending Chapter 65 of the Legislative Code pertaining to golf courses.

Nellie Jerome, City Planner, gave a staff report and answered councilmember questions.

Laid over to July 22, 2026 for Second Reading

26 Ord 26-36 Adding Chapter 86.13 to the Administrative Code to require City Council approval of Mixed Municipal Solid Waste contracts.

Council President Noecker spoke to the ordinance.

Laid over to July 22, 2026 for Second Reading

PUBLIC HEARINGS
Live testimony is limited to two minutes for each person. See below for optional ways to testify.

27 Ord 26-32 Amending Appendix C of the Legislative Code relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Electric Franchise.

John Purdy, resident, spoke during the public hearing.

Lily Eggers, resident, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Jost moved to close the public hearing.

Laid over to July 22, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

28 Ord 26-33 Amending Appendix B of the Legislative Code relating to Northern States Power, D/B/A Xcel Energy, Gas Franchise.

John Purdy, resident, spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Jost moved to close the public hearing.

Laid over to July 22, 2026 for Final Adoption

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

29 RES PH 26-153 Approving the application of Irish Fair of MN for a sound level variance in order to present amplified sound for a Twin Cities Irish Fest event on August 7, 8, and 9, 2026, at 200 Dr. Justus Ohage Blvd - Harriet Island Regional Park.

Councilmember Yang moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING DISCUSSION ITEM

33 RLH RSA 26-7 Appeal of Tenant, Michael Smith to a Rent Stabilization Determination at 1517 PORTLAND AVENUE APT D.

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report.

Abby Hanson, attorney from the Housing Justice Center, spoke during the public hearing.

Michael Smith, appellant, spoke during the public hearing.

Robin Doroshow & Richard Kronfeld, property owners, spoke during the public hearing.

Moermond answered questions from Councilmember Bowie.

Bowie moved approval.

Adopted

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

31 RLH TA 26-125 Ratifying the Appealed Special Tax Assessment for property at 720 COTTAGE AVENUE EAST. (File No. 2604T, Assessment No. 269003)

Marcia Moermond, Legislative Hearing Officer, gave a staff report.

Three people spoke during the public hearing.

Councilmember Johnson moved to close the public hearing.

Public hearing closed, no further action taken, laid over to July 22, 2026

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

LEGISLATIVE HEARING CONSENT AGENDA

Items listed under the Consent Agenda will receive a combined public hearing and be enacted by one motion with no separate discussion. Items may be removed from the Consent Agenda for a separate public hearing and discussion if desired.

Approval of the Consent Agenda

Councilmember Johnson moved approval.

Legislative Hearing Consent Agenda adopted as amended

Yea: 7 - Councilmember Noecker, Councilmember Yang, Councilmember Kim, Councilmember Bowie, Councilmember Jost, Councilmember Johnson and Councilmember Coleman

Nay: 0

30 RLH SAO 26-41 Second Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 399 BLAIR AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 26-16. (Public hearing continued to July 15, 2026; Legislative Hearing July 14, 2026)

Adopted as amended (granted to January 12, 2027 to have building materials removed or building permit closed)

32 RLH SAO 25-73 Making finding on the appealed nuisance abatement ordered for 1473 FAIRMOUNT AVENUE in Council File RLH SAO 25-66.

Adopted

34 RLH RR 26-12 Ordering the rehabilitation or razing and removal of the structures at 594-596 REANEY AVENUE within fifteen (15) days after the July 15, 2026, City Council Public Hearing. (July 14, 2026 Legislative Hearing)

Public hearing continued to August 5, 2026

35 RLH AR 26-42 Ratifying the assessment for Removal of Diseased and/or Dangerous Tree(s) service during February 2026. (File No. 2604T, Assessment No. 269003)

Adopted

36 RLH AR 26-43 Ratifying the assessment for Demolition of Vacant, Nuisance and/or Hazardous Structure from the month of March 2026. (File No. J2606C, Assessment No. 262005)

Adopted

ADJOURNMENT

Meeting ended at 4:36 PM

City Council meetings are open for in person attendance, but the public may also comment on public hearing items in writing. Any comments and materials submitted by 12:00 pm of the day before the meeting will be attached to the public record and available for review by the City Council. Comments may be submitted as follows:

Written public comment on public hearing items can be submitted to Contact-Council@ci.stpaul.mn.us or CouncilHearing@ci.stpaul.mn.us. Live testimony will be taken in person in the Council Chambers.

Council Meeting Information
The City Council is paperless which saves the environment and reduces expenses. The agendas and Council files are all available on the Web (see below). Council members use mobile devices to review the files during the meeting. Using a mobile device greatly reduces costs since most agendas, including the documents attached to files, are over 1000 pages when printed.

Web
Meetings are available on the Council's website. Email notification and web feeds (RSS) of newly released minutes, agendas, and meetings are available by subscription. Visit www.stpaul.gov/council for meeting videos and updated copies of the agendas, minutes, and supporting documents.

Cable
Meetings are live on St Paul Channel 18 and replayed at various times. Check your local listings.